

Useful spelling rules

- The “**ee**” sound at the end of a word is almost always spelled with a **y**, as in **emergency** and **dependency**. There are exceptions to this rule, such as **fee** and **coffee**.
- When **all** and **well** are followed by another syllable, they only have one **l**, as in **already** and **welcome**.
- When **full** and **till** are joined to a root syllable, the final **l** should be dropped, as in **useful** and **until**.
- When **two vowels** go walking, **the first one** does the talking. This means that when there are two vowels next to each other in a word, the first one represents the sound made when spoken, while the second vowel is silent, as in **approach** and **leather**. There are some exceptions to this rule, including **great** and **build**.
- When words end in a **silent -e**, drop the **silent -e** when adding endings that begin with a vowel: for example, when adding **-ing** to **give** to form **giving**. Keep the **silent -e** when adding endings that begin with a consonant: for example, when adding **-s** to **give** to form **gives**.
- If a word ends with an “**ick**” sound, spell it using **ick** if it has one syllable, as in **click** and **brick**. If the word has two or more syllables, spell it using **ic**, as in **electronic** and **catastrophic**. Some exceptions to this rule include **homesick** and **limerick**.
- The letter **q** is usually followed by a **u**, as in **quiet** and **sequence**.

Mnemonics and fun spelling tips

affect and effect
Affect is the **action**;
effect is the **result**.

dilemma
Emma faced
a dilemma.

ocean
Only cats’ eyes
are narrow.

misspells
Miss Pells never
misspells.

desert and dessert
What’s the difference between
deserts and desserts? Desserts
are sweeter with **two s’s**
for sugars.

soldier
Soldiers sometimes
die in battle.

difficulty
Mrs. **D**, Mrs. **I**,
Mrs. **FFI**, Mrs. **C**,
Mrs. **U**, Mrs. **LTY**.

height and weight
There is an **eight** in
height and **weight**.

secretary
A **secretary** must
keep a **secret**.

island
An island **is land** that is
surrounded by water.

measurement
You should be **sure** of your
measurements before you
start work.

piece
You have to have a
pie before you can
have a **piece**.

hear
Hear with
your **ear**.